Here's To My Yesterday

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Catra & Melog (She-Ra)

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by catrasredemption (dimensionhoppingrose)

Summary

-Magicatra AU, part of a series-

"We dont *have* to do this."

Catra sighs, looking down the stairs to the underground kingdom. She can feel Adora's eyes on her, searching for some reassurance that she's okay. Melog is next to her, pressed up against her side.

She's right. It can wait.

"No, it's fine," Catra says, dismissing them both. "Let's just go."

-OR-

A year after the war, Catra takes Melog and Adora to Half Moon to sort out some unfinished business.

Notes

idk why I got the urge to write this, but it wouldn't leave me alone, so here we are!

This is post-Smoke and Mirrors, and yeah, you really, really have to have read the series to follow this.

Keeping in the tradition of titling stories in this series, this title is also from an Imagine Dragons song.

See the end of the work for more notes

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"No, it's fine," Catra says, dismissing them both. "Let's just go."

They start down the stairs in silence. Bow and Glimmer had offered to join them, but Catra had just wanted to go with Melog. Adora, being Adora, hadn't given her a choice on the matter.

They reach the gap where the stairs had collapsed. Catra jumps down while Melog helps Adora. They give a sad, mournful mewl, brushing against Catra's leg.

Are you sure about this?

No. Catra doesn't bother saying the answer out loud; she just pats their head and makes her way into the village. Melog bounds ahead a bit to scout things out while Adora stays at Catra's side, taking her hand and squeezing.

"Are you okay?"

"Yeah." Catra keeps her eyes ahead, watching as Melog slips into one of the houses. Their grief is like a blackhole in the back of Catra's mind. Usually the bond between them is fairly quiet, unless one of them got really emotional. And that isn't something that happens often with Melog. She squeezes her eyes shut, taking a deep breath.

"That doesn't seem fine," Adora says with a frown.

"Melog is upset."

"So are you." It isn't a question. Catra bites down her annoyance at Adora's confident tone. She knows Catra. Of course she knows Catra. It's almost impossible for her to play off any kind of emotion because Adora is always watching her like a hawk.

"Their feelings matter more right now," Catra says dismissively, turning away.

"I don't think it works that way," Adora says quietly. Catra ignores her, watching Melog exit the house. Their ears are drooping, their usually bright mane somehow dimmer.

"I want to give them a proper burial," she tells Melog. "I'm not really sure how to do that, though. Are there any funeral traditions or anything?"

I can help with that, Melog assures her with a nod. They seem a little bolstered by the idea of giving the rest of the Magicats a *real* resting place.

"Um... Where exactly do you think you can bury them?" Adora asks, looking around. "There isn't much room around here."

"Maybe up in the Wastes?" Catra looks back toward the entrance. "Plenty of room there. And I doubt anyone will mind if we take up a bit of sand or something."

"Fair enough. How um... How do you plan on getting them up there, though?"

That is the hard part. Catra has no idea. She couldn't exactly carry all the bones up there. She'd probably end up ruining them. And the last thing she wants to do is disrespect the dead when she's *trying* to give them a final burial place.

"I'm not sure," she admits, dropping to sit on the ground with her legs curled under herself. Adora sits with her, and Melog comes over to

nudge her forehead with their snout. "I didn't really think this through, huh?"

"That's nothing new ," Adora teases, nudging her shoulder against Catra's. "When was the last time either of us thought *anything* through?"

"Hey , I'll have you know I always have a plan," Catra teases back, smiling weakly.

"Uh huh. So when you strolled onto Horde Prime's ship without any idea what you were doing and no clue that you still had access to She-Ra, that was... a plan?"

"Are you complaining? I saved you, didn't I?"

"And you're *never* going to let me live it down." Adora rolls her eyes. "And going down to the Heart with the Failsafe knowing it would probably kill you. That was also a plan?"

Catra rolls her eyes right back at Adora, giving her a shove. "Listen, you're not exactly the master of brilliant plans yourself. I don't hear you coming up with anything better."

Adora looks at the house they're sitting in front of, then at Catra, then at Melog. "Actually , I *do* have an idea." She kisses Catra's cheek and stands. "Mind if I borrow Melog for a minute?"

"Go for it. But what"—

"Great, be back in a bit!"

She clambers onto Melog's back, and they disappear back toward the entrance. Catra watches them go, shaking her head, and stands, wandering further into the village.

And, inevitably, her mind goes back to the portal reality. The world where she and Adora had lived in this place *together* , where Catra had been a princess and Adora had been a knight-in-training. Where

they'd walked the castle grounds and the streets together, known and loved by the entire kingdom. Where she'd had parents who truly cared about her, and only wanted what was best for her. Where Adora had continued living after she had trapped herself in the portal.

Sometimes, Catra wonders if that world was better. She wonders if Adora misses it. There were times where Adora seemed to get confused, like she couldn't quite remember what reality she was in. And that was fair – she had lived in that place for ten years. She'd married Catra, they'd had a child together, they'd made an entire *life* together. It's natural for Adora to get confused. And she's getting better. It had been almost a year since she'd been rescued from the portal, and her slips in reality sre getting less frequent. But sometimes, Catra will catch her with a distant look in her eyes, like she's staring at something only she can see. And Catra knows she's thinking about the portal world. Probably about Finn. She talks about them a lot. Does she *want* kids? It isn't really something they'd talked about. There hadn't been time, given all the work they'd been doing to rebuild Etheria and restore trust in the princesses. Not to mention all the work they'd had to do in the former Fright Zone. And they were still navigating their relationship, learning the ins and outs of things, getting to re-know each other. Kids are pretty low on the list of things to talk about.

But still, Catra wonders.

She stops as she approaches the castle, looking up at it. It had probably been beautiful once, before the Horde attack that had wiped out the entire kingdom. She wonders what the queen had been like. Queens? There had been two in the portal reality. Angella or Micah would probably know, but Catra's scared to ask. She isn't sure if she wants to know. Would it be better or worse if they confirmed that there had been at least some truth to the life that could have been? That Catra was the princess of this lost kingdom, and she had failed it not only as the warrior meant to protect the entire planet, but as its future ruler as well?

Catra doesn't go into the castle. She doesn't want to look for bodies in there. instead, she collapses on the steps, pulling her mask off and staring at it dismally. She'd been a kid when the Horde had attacked —practically a baby. Logically, she knows there was nothing she could have done then to save anyone in Half Moon. It was pure luck she had been allowed to survive (if one wants to call *Shadow Weaver* a lucky thing). But this had all happened because of the mask. Because one selfish sorceress wanted more power. If it hadn't been here - if it hadn't existed, if it hadn't chosen Catra... would things have turned out differently? What would her life be if one little thing had changed?

Adora and Melog still haven't returned. Catra wonders vaguely what they're doing, then realizes she isn't sure she cares. She just starts walking again, back into the village. She peers into one of the shops, her heart dropping when she sees the pile of bones that had once been a living magicat —someone just like her. There had *been* people like her. She'd grown up feeling isolated, like she was the only one in the world who was *like this*. And in a way, she was right. But it hadn't always been that way. She could have had more. She could have had a real family.

Another thing to thank Shadow Weaver for.

Her ears twitch when she heard bells in the air;she turns to see Glimmer, Micah, Castaspella, and Melog appear behind her.

"What are you guys"—

"We're here to help,"Glimmer says brightly. Castaspella draws a glyph in the air, and the bones in the shop start glowing, carefully lifting into the air. "Adora said you couldn't figure out how to move everyone, and well... we weren't doing anything, so..."

"Where *is* Adora?"Catra asks, looking around. The blonde's absence is noticeable.

"Up above with Bow , Scorpia, Netossa, Spinnerella, and Perfuma helping dig graves." Glimmer tsks. "I can't believe you really thought you were going to do all of this on your own." Micah had started of f toward the castle, and Glimmer starts off in the other direction. "Y ou really are ridiculous sometimes."

Melog walks over to Catra, nudging her hand and mewling. *Yo u always seem to g et that you h ave to d o everything a lone* .

Catra looks down at them, patting their head without thought. "Y eah. I guess I'm still learning. So, how do we do this?"

It takes most of the day, but with some magic and Melog's help, they manage to get everyone above ground. *Try to k eep f amilies t ogether* , Melog says, with Catra translating. *I kn ow it's hard to l et b if g of in d them m ove s togethe r , they're p rotected. B est to b e saf e a bit.*

The diggers have been busy;they'd dug out a large hole, easily a hundred feet wide, with Perfuma providing dirt to help stabiliz e the walls of the hole so nothing collapsed. They all look ex hausted, but proud of themselves. Catra stares at the hole, then at her friends.

"Are... you crying?" Bow asks, eyebrows furrowing in concern.

"No!" Catra protests, scrubbing her eyes furiously . "I just... have sand in my eyes."

Glimmer appears behind Catra, hugging her tight. "It's okay Catra, you can admit you love us."

Catra shoves her away without really trying. "Shut up."

"W e talked to Huntara, too!" Scorpia pipes up. "She said she'll make sure everyone knows this area is off limits, and if anyone tries to mess with it... there were some gruesome threats, let's put it that way."

"They were *extremely* colorful," Adora agrees.

"And of course, we'll put up some barriers of our own to protect it," Micah adds, resting a hand on Catra's shoulder. "Half Moon used to be an ally. I'm sorry we failed to protect it then, but we'll do everything we can now."

Catra ducks her head to hide the tears filling her eyes again. No one says anything about it this time. Melog winds around her legs, purring loudly.

You have got friends.

"Yeah. They're all right sometimes."

The sun is setting by the time they finally finish the burial. Perfuma sprinkles some seeds across the sand once the last of the hole had been filled in, and flowers bloom to life among the cacti, marking the area. To an outsider, it doesn't look like a mass grave, and that actually makes Catra feel a little better. It's a beautiful place that might even bring a smile to someone's lips if they see it.

Bow starts a small fire for them to sit around and relax while Castaspella and Micah cast the protection spells around the area. Catra sits with Adora, leaning against her and closing her eyes.

"Thanks," she says quietly. Adora rests her head against Catra's.

"Nothing to thank me for. This was important to you, so it's important to me."

"Does it." Catra hesitates, chewing over her words, trying to consider how exactly she wants to ask this. "Does anything about this place feel familiar to you?"

"You mean is it like the dream reality?" Catra nods. "I'm not really sure. I was up here more helping with digging." Catra suspects there's a reason for that. "But I did get kind of a weird déjà vu feeling

when I was looking at the castle." Adora looks at her hands, tangling her fingers together. "I'm trying not to think too much about it. Do you know if you're?..."

"Nope. There isn't really anyone to ask. Angella said she met the princess when she was a baby, but that was years ago."

"What um. What about the queens?"

Catra shakes her head. She'd thought about it all day, and is still no closer to knowing if that's something she wants confirmed or not. If the identity of the queens and the princess *are* better lost to history. Or If she's just being selfish about it.

Adora seems to sense that they've reached the end of the conversation, and falls silent again, staring at the fire. The rest of the group is chattering around them, adding some levity to the heavy atmosphere. Melog is inspecting the protection spells, pressing their snout against it at random intervals while Casta and Micah watch, clearly waiting for their judgment.

"What about the rest of the kingdom?" Adora asks curiously, looking back toward the entrance. Catra casts a weary glance at it.

"I want to let Melog go through it – they need the closure." Their sadness has been an ever-present void in the back of Catra's mind all day. She knows, no matter what she says, that they would always blame themself for this, just a little. "After that... I dunno, let one of Bow's brothers have a go at it? Someone is going to find it eventually, and at least I know someone from his family would be a little more respectful about it. I don't know, I just don't want to let the memory die, I guess. Like, if everyone forgets the Magicats existed, it'll be like they were never here. Or they'll be remembered through the First Ones' version of events."

Her expression darkens at the thought. The First Ones had completely disgraced the Magicats in *their* version of history. Catra isn't sure that damage was fixable.

"You *literally* saved the entire universe from a galactic overlord," Adora reminds Catra. "No one is going to forget the Magicats existed."

"I don't want to be the *only* one anyone remembers, though." Catra wouldn't've been happy not being remembered at all, but she's pretty sure she doesn't get a say in that. "It's not *just* about me. There's been an entire kingdom under the Crimson Wastes that everyone just *forgot* about for over twenty years. And anyone who *did* know anything about them only knew the story the First Ones told. The Magicats deserve better than that. They *actually* cared about this planet and the people living here. They wanted to protect it."

History is written by the victors. It's something Razz had told Catra a lot. The people who won controlled the narrative. Once upon a time, that had been the first ones. But they're gone, and Catra is still here. She can make sure the real story is told. She'd keep the Magicats' memory alive no matter what it took.

Melog shrinks down to crawl into her lap, curling up. *As long as one person remembers*, they say quietly, *then their memory will always live on.*

Catra pats their head, smiling faintly. "Yeah." She looks up at her friends, and clears her throat. "Hey, guys?" Heads turn to her one by one. "I just wanted to say thank you for taking the time to help with all this. I'm sure Glimmer and Adora just grabbed you from whatever you were doing and didn't actually give you a *choice*, but I really appreciate it."

"We're always happy to help!" Perfuma assures her with a smile.

"And we weren't really doing much," Bow adds.

"Speak for yourself," Netossa says. "*We* were getting donuts in Elberon."

"And you didn't even bring us any? Rude."

"Maybe we would have if Glimmer hadn't just appeared behind us and grabbed us before we could finish paying."

Adora laces her fingers through Catra's, giving them a tight squeeze. "I'm not sorry," she says. She had known Catra wanted to deal with this alone. But she had also known that simply wasn't a practical option.

"I definitely don't expect you to be."

They sit there for about an hour, exchanging stories in quiet voices and enjoying the unimpeded view of the stars, before Glimmer starts taking people home. Melog disappears back down into Half Moon; Catra watches them go, debating, then stands to follow.

"I'll be right back," she assures Adora, resting a hand on her shoulder. "Don't let Sparkles abandon me here."

"I'll do my best."

Melog is standing on the edge of the village when Catra finds them. She sits beside them, resting a hand on their head. "I'm sorry I couldn't protect them."

You were a child. There is nothing to apologize for.

Catra isn't sure she agrees with that, but she can't argue, either. "I promise, I'm going to make sure they have the *right* place in history. No one will ever forget them."

Melog purrs, touching their snout to Catra's cheek. *I know.*

They sit in silence for a long moment—each the remaining survivor of their own kind. Alone in the universe. But not really. They have each other. They have their friends. They'll be okay.

Adora, Bow, and Glimmer are waiting by the fire when Catra and Melog finally return. Bow and Glimmer immediately wrap Catra in a tight hug while Adora watches, amused.

"Yeah, yeah." Catra pats their backs, smiling fondly. "Come on, let's get home. I'm exhausted."

"Bossy," Glimmer says with a scoff, rolling her eyes. "Fine, no heartfelt group hug for you."

"Oh no, what a shame."

Catra steps away to look at the gathering of flowers and cacti. The sight gives her just a little bit of peace. The Magicats ~~-her~~ people ~~-can~~ finally rest. They've been given the burial they had deserved.

"How do we close it?" Adora asks curiously, looking up at the giant opening into the desolate kingdom.

"I think I can... hang on."

Catra steps toward the cliff wall, pressing a hand to the edge of the opening. The cliff glows as the hole shrinks in on itself, coming together with a loud rumbling noise, and concealing Half Moon once more. She'd be back at some point to open this place again for Bow's family, but that's for some time in the future.

For now, she steps back, taking Adora's hand, and bracing herself for the trip home.

End Notes

Thoughts? Would people be interested in more one-shots in this series? Let me know!

Please drop by the archive and comment to let the author know if you enjoyed their work!